
THE SUNNY SOUTH OÖLOGIST.

Vol. 1, No. 2.

GAINESVILLE, TEXAS, APRIL, 1886.

Published Monthly.
50 Cents per Year.

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***** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE SUNNY
SOUTH OÖLOGIST. VOL. 1, NO. 2 *****

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Notes from Southern California.

We have been having a bountiful share of rain in this neighborhood of late; and while we have been having warm drenching rains in the low lands, there has been a steady fall of snow in the mountains. As a result of the latter fact large numbers of Cedarbirds, Robins, Catbirds, etc., have left their usual haunts (the mountains), and taken refuge in our warm orange groves and vineyards. And now a person cannot walk a mile through the suburbs of the town, without noticing several large flocks of these birds feeding contentedly by the roadside, or industriously probing among decayed limbs, or under dead leaves for bugs and larvæ, upon which they delight to feed. These birds however do not breed in this locality, but as soon as the warm weather sets in, they betake themselves to the remote valleys and fastnesses, situated among the almost inaccessible ranges of the Sierra Madre. Here all are protected from the ravages of that “fell egg-destroyer,” the school-boy. They breed and rear their young in peace, and we see no more of them until the next “cold spell” sets in and causes them to again visit us, or properly speaking, “our warm climate,” until the clemency of the weather will again permit them to return to their accustomed haunts. Further north however these birds can be found among the woods and forests the whole year 'round.

At this season of the year we are not alone favored with visits of the land birds, but the aquatic element is very abundantly and variously represented among our ponds and streams; in fact, out of a bag of twenty or thirty ducks, which a hunter may be so fortunate as to secure as a reward for a day's sport, he can generally single out from twelve to fifteen different species, from the majestic old Mallard or “Greenhead,” to the diminutive Butterball or “Silkduck.” Quite a number of these ducks remain with us during the breeding season; in fact I have personally obtained “sets” of eggs of the Cinnamon Teal, Baldpate, Mallard, Ruddy Duck, Godwall, Redhead, Pintail and Greenwinged Teal; besides I have heard several authentic accounts of “sets” of some other species of ducks being secured by other

Oologists in different portions of this county. The principal or most profitable grounds on which to successfully search for nests of various species of ducks and other waterfowl is amongst the immense "tule lands" and sloughs of a marsh called "Gospel Swamp." This is a place about sixty miles from Los Angeles, and occupying many square miles of country, including the bogs, willow swamps, tidelands, etc. It is a veritable paradise for ducks of all species; and during the sporting season I have spent some very pleasant and well repaid time, by trudging around its extremities, armed with a good ten-bore "breech-loader," with an evil intent upon the unsuspecting ducks and geese. Notwithstanding the thousands and thousands of birds annually slaughtered in these swamps by the professional "pot" or market hunters, as well as the havoc wrought by amateur sportsmen, still the number of the birds never decrease to a perceptible extent; but, like the "Hydra," where you kill one to-day, you will find two to-morrow. Along towards spring the birds begin to assemble together in vast flocks of countless thousands, and depart for unknown latitudes in the "far north." Their time of departure seems to be invariably during the night; in fact I have often noticed large numbers of ducks 14 assembling at the same given lake or pond. This congregating would perhaps occupy a lapse of several days, the numbers apparently augmented by large additions each succeeding night. At length, after a vast number has congregated, you will notice a great deal of excitement among the large flocks; a seeming dissatisfaction and restlessness, evinced by loud calls and continual fluttering, splashing, etc. After all these signs of busy life, if you visit the lake the next morning you will probably find it lonely and deserted, without a vestige of yesterday's tumult and life, save a few lonely, sick looking Teals, who were too weak or tired perhaps to join the flight of their fellows the preceding night. But they may wait for the next flight which at once begins to form, with new additions each succeeding night, and in a few days we have an exact repetition of the assemblage and flight of a few days previous. The assembling of these birds is usually at some large lake convenient for their purpose, and the additions in the shape of small straggling flocks, are very probably detachments of ducks which have left the small ponds and streams, where they have passed the winter in detached flocks, and as if by some previously concerted plan assemble here so as to take their departure *en masse* for the possible view of both company and protection.

A. M. SHIELDS,

Los Angeles, Cal.

North American Birds.

I will hereafter give in this column each month, as near as possible, the breeding places, and the time of nesting of the Birds of North America; beginning this month with the family Turdidae.

1. WOOD THRUSH—*Hylocichla Mustelina*—Nests usually found in low, damp woods. Dates of nesting, from May 10th to June 15th.
2. WILSON'S THRUSH—*Hylocichla fuscesceus*—The situation of the nest is retired, and often in the depths of woods. Begins nesting about May 20th.
3. GRAY-CHEEKED THRUSH—*Hylocichla aliciae*—Low, damp woods and thickets. Begins nesting about May 1st.
4. RUSSET-BACKED THRUSH—*Hylocichla ustulata*—Pacific coast regions abundant. Begins nesting about May 15th.
- 4a. OLIVE-BACKED THRUSH—*Hylocichla ustulata swainsoni*—Dry, scrubby woods. Begins nesting about June 1st.
5. DWARF THRUSH—*Hylocichla unalascae*—Thick woods and swamps. Begins nesting early in May.
- 5b. HERMIT THRUSH—*Hylocichla unalascae pallasi*—Low, swampy places. Begins nesting June 1st.
7. AMERICAN ROBIN—*Merula Migratoria*—Nests made near habitations. Nests from May 1st to July 25th.
- 7a. WESTERN ROBIN—*Merula Migratoria propinqua*—Nesting habits similar to that of No. 7.
9. VARIED ROBIN—*Hesperocichla naevia*—Inhabits all woodland. Begins nesting about May 10th.

10. SAGE THRASHER—*Oreoscoptes montanus*—Inhabits open, mountainous countries. Begins nesting May 15th.

11. MOCKING BIRD—*Mimus polyglottus*—Nests placed in open country, orchards, vineyards, etc. Always near man. Begins nesting April 20th.

12. CATBIRD—*Galeoscoptes carolinensis*—In gardens or clearings of woods, always near habitations. Nests May 15th to July 1st.

13. BROWN THRASHER—*Harporhynchus rufus*—In blackberry tangle or thickets, high or low land. May 10th to June 20th.

13a. MEXICAN BROWN THRASHER—*Harporhynchus rufus longirostris*—Nesting places similar to foregoing species. Nests April 15th to June 15th. 15

14. SAINT LUCAS THRASHER—*Harporhynchus cinereus xantus*—Uplands and high plains, in cactus and other bushes. Begins nesting about May 1st.

14a. BENDIRE'S THRASHER—*Harporhynchus cinereus bendirei*—Uplands and high plains. Begins nesting April 1st.

15. CURVE-BILLED THRASHER—*Harporhynchus curvirostris*—Inhabits thick woods. Nest from May 1st to June 15th.

15a. PALMER'S THRASHER—*Harporhynchus curvirostris palmeri*—Desert regions of Arizona. Begins nesting about the 10th of May.

16. CALIFORNIA THRASHER—*Harporhynchus redivivus*—Coast region of California, in a clump of bushes, or dense chaparral. Begins nesting early in February.

16a. LECONTE'S THRASHER—*Harporhynchus redivivus lecontei*—Frequents open countries. Begins nesting early in April.

17. RUFUS-VENTED THRASHER—*Harporhynchus crissalis*—Common in chapparral thickets, and well shaded undergrowths. Begins nesting early in April.

(Continued.)

Egg Collecting in Colorado.

On a pleasant morning in the early part of May last, (May 2, 1885) our collector put his gun, collecting-box, etc., into the buckboard, and started for a point 16 miles below Greeley, on the Platte. The destination was a long island midway in the Platte while on either side was the rushing, dirty river. This island was noted among the boys of the neighborhood as a great resort for crows, owls, herons and other large birds during the breeding season; but, owing to the river being high in the spring of the year few have ever cared to reach the island for such "trifles as bird's-eggs." 'Twas too early for herons' eggs, too late for owl's, but just the time for crows. The latter we were after, and crows' eggs we determined to have. The sight of a few nests in the trees on the island, and several crows flapping about, worked our desires to the highest pitch. Stripping and holding all necessary articles to take crow's eggs with in one hand, we partly waded and swam across the wild and dirty stream to the crow-den shores. In a short space of time I took 11 sets of 6 eggs, and 3 of 5 each from nests from 12 to 20 feet from the ground, all eggs were perfectly fresh. Once I thought I had a set of Raven's eggs (280), as they were larger than the average crow's, and my aid shot a female raven as she left the nest. It must have been a mistake however on *her* part and I have since given up the idea.

I flushed an American Long-Eared owl (395) off of an old crow's nest about 8 feet from the ground, and obtained a handsome set of 6 eggs. It was so late in the season for owl's eggs that I was afraid they would hatch out before I could get them to the ground. On blowing them I was much surprised to find them all perfectly fresh. Has any one ever taken a fresh set of 395 as late as this?

Also took one set of B. B. magpies (286) 5 eggs, incubation well advanced; nest 6 feet from the ground. We saw several herons busily fixing up their old nests in the high tops of a large cottonwood, but we never get fresh heron's eggs until the last of May.

FRED M. DILLE,

Greeley, Colorado.

Nesting of Brown-headed Nuthatch.

(SITTA PUSSILLA)

All the accounts I have seen in books say the brown-headed nuthatch builds no nest, but lays her eggs in the bottom of a hollow in the tree on the 16 decayed wood. Now, I have never found one that did not make an attempt to build a nest. I have found several, ranging from two to forty feet from the ground, and in every case a nest was built, composed of fibrous roots, pieces of hanging moss, hair and feathers mixed together. The nests were built in a hollow in a decayed tree, from one foot to three feet deep. The nest is very loosely put together, and it is impossible to remove it without cutting the cavity open to the bottom of the nest. A gentleman in California, who is well versed in Ornithology and Oology, who I wrote to in regard to it, says his knowledge and experience has been in almost every case, that a nest is attempted by this bird—the description of a nest taken by him in Orange county, Fla., some years ago is—the nest was composed of pieces of fibrous, decayed wood, small scales of pine bark, wings of pine seeds, and a little woolly vegetable material arranged in cup form.

G. NOBLE,

Savannah, Georgia.

A Bird's Sagacity.

For the Sunny South Oologist:

The following little narrative occurred at my old home in Kentucky, some years ago: I had placed over the roof of my house a bird box, and for several years the martins had occupied it, and I think the same pair came back every year, for the male appeared larger and had a coarser voice (?) than any others I had ever heard.

This spring of which I speak, the blue birds had taken possession of the box, and one morning while out for a little fresh air I heard the welcomed voice of the martin in the distance. I turned to see from where the voice came, and saw the old friend coming alone. He came directly to the bird box, and appeared very much surprised to find it occupied, so at once began an attack upon the inmates, but the little birds were too much for the old martin, and he had to give up to them. (But this was only for a short time.) So he flew to a neighboring roof, and sat there for a time as if meditating what to do, and then flew in a direct line toward the south from whence he had come. The little blue birds seemed to congratulate themselves upon their victory, but they were too soon, for the next morning at about the same time, I heard the voice which seemed to say "pitch in, pitch in," and I knew he was coming. Upon looking I saw him in the lead with about a dozen other martins following. I waited to see his purpose, and was not long in finding it out, for he flew direct to the bird box, and perching himself on the top gave the orders, "Pitch in! pitch in!" and they did pitch in from both sides.

* * * * *

It is needless to say how it terminated, for the old martin and his mate raised a brood that year, and came year after year until I came west.

L. L. HOWARD,

Gainesville, Texas.

A Georgia paper says that before the war there was a bird in the south that fed exclusively on cockle-burrs. At a certain season of the year these birds would sweep down on the fields and when they departed not a burr remained. The smell of burnt and burning powder for four years seems to have been too much for the burr-eaters. Since then not a bird of the kind is to be found in the south; but the burrs are here yet.

Early Finds.

I think I will enter the lists in competition for “earliness.” I opened the ball on January 30th, 1886, by taking a set of three of the Great Horned Owl, incubation advanced. Who can beat it?

The following are the earliest takes of each species named during 1885. March 27th, Pileated Woodpecker, Cardinal Grosbeak; April 2nd, Turkey-Buzzard, Black Vulture, Tufted Titmouse; April 7th, Carolina Chickadee, Kildeer; April 10th, Swallow-tailed Kite; April 11th, Texan Screech Owl, Carolina Dove; April 15th, Red-bellied Woodpecker; April 17th, Yellow-throated Vireo; April 20th, Common Crow, Wild Turkey; April 27th, Mockingbird; April 28th, Carolina Wren; May 4th, Yellow-billed Cuckoo, Dwarf Cowbird; May 8th, Lark Finch, Scissor-tailed Flycatcher, Texas Orchard Oriole, Yellow-winged Sparrow; May 9th, Black-throated Bunting, Painted Bunting, Summer Red-bird; May 11th, Texan Quail, Blue Grosbeak; May 18th, Meadow Lark; May 22nd, Blue-gray Gnatcatcher; June 3d, Bronzed Grackle; June 8th, Boat-tailed Grackle; June 19th, Kingbird, the second set that I have taken in Texas during six years' collecting.

J. A. SINGLEY,

Giddings, Texas.

The Scissor-tailed Flycatcher.

(MILVULUS FORFICATUS (GM.) SWAINS.)

This beautiful bird is one of the commonest summer residents of North Texas. They usually arrive from the south about the 15th of April in small flocks or pairs, and always make themselves known by their loud and noise-some voices. This bird has a very peculiar way when flying, of stopping—as it appears—in the air, and then making a straight shoot upward to the height of fifteen or twenty feet, and instantly darting downward to about a level with where it started. This is always repeated two or three times before taking their onward flight. While making this tumble as it were, it always gives loud, quick screams, and is very conspicuous by the display it makes in opening and closing the tail like scissor blades. It is a very active, dashing and noisy bird; also very showy and graceful. The general color is a hoary-ash, almost white below, with a scarlet crown patch, and a bright scarlet on the sides at insertion of wings. The wings have a blackish cast with whitish underparts, and various parts of the body are tinged with a rich salmon. Most of the tail feathers are black or dusky, while some of the longer ones are mostly white or rosy; these feathers are long and narrow, sometimes reaching a foot in length. The above description is that of a male now lying before me. The female averages smaller, and the tail is much shorter, while the color of the plumage is duller than that of the male.

They begin to nest about the 10th of May, and fresh eggs may be found as late as June 25th. The nest and eggs resemble those of the kingbird very much, and it is almost impossible to distinguish them from each other, unless they are well identified; but, as a general thing, the scissor-tails' eggs have larger and more conspicuous blotches than those of the kingbird. During the summer of '85 I found nests of the kingbird and scissor tail in the same tree, and the nests and eggs were identically the same; so to make sure of the identity, I had to wait until both birds had occupied their own nest.

Their favorite nesting places are in the scrubby postoak and mesquite bushes growing on our broad prairies. The nests are usually placed in forks at from six to thirty feet from the ground, and constructed of various materials, such as weed-tops, wool, cotton, rootlets, paper, rags, etc., and lined with fibrous roots, wool, cotton, etc.

The number of eggs laid are usually four or five in number, of a rounded-oval shape, the color being white, boldly blotched or marked with reddish-brown, and obscure lavender shell markings, chiefly at the larger end. The size of the eggs averages about .67 by .85.

E. C. DAVIS.

—THE—
Sunny South Oologist

A MONTHLY DEVOTED TO THE INTERESTS OF ORNITHOLOGISTS AND OOLOGISTS.

EDITED AND PUBLISHED BY
EDWIN C. DAVIS,
GAINESVILLE, TEXAS.

We request all of our readers to send us descriptions of their collecting trips, or any items of interest relating to birds, their nests or eggs.

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EDITORIAL DEPARTMENT.

With this month's issue I make my first bow to the Ornithologists and Oologists of America. I refrained from so doing in the first issue as I did not know at the time how my little journal would be received. But, as I have had so many encouraging words from my friends in every part of North America, I will now promise henceforth to give you the most reliable and best reading matter obtainable, and shall try my utmost to make this magazine a great help in the advancement of that most delightful branch of natural history—Ornithology and Oology. Trusting that my friends will be as well pleased with this and the following numbers, as with the first, I remain,

Yours very sincerely,

EDWIN C. DAVIS.

Easter comes this month, so don't fail to look for the "rabbit" nests.

Don't fail to read the great offers to "club-getters" on the inside page of first cover leaf.

Our "Exchange and Want" column is worth the price of a year's subscription alone to subscribers, in helping them make exchanges.

We will stick to our first promise; that is, we will enlarge our paper as soon as we are convinced it will pay us. So do not delay, but subscribe at once. The price is only 50 cents per year.

What do you think of the appearance of “our” little journal this month? Don’t you think you have been fully repaid already for the small amount invested—fifty cents—for a year’s subscription?

Collectors look for the nests of the crow, chickadee, nuthatch and hawk this month. You will find the chickadee’s and nuthatche’s the latter part of the month, while the hawks and crows breed earlier.

Two Canvas-back ducks were killed near Gainesville, Tex. on the 22nd of February. They were very handsome specimens, and a rare avis in this section. They were the first I think ever seen in this county.

The article written by Mr. Harry G. Parker, entitled “Pennsylvania Birds,” is one of great value to Oologists (old and young) in Pennsylvania and adjacent states, as it gives the correct nesting seasons of birds found in that locality, and also tells the nature of country in which their nests are found. This article was compiled for the editor as a special favor, by Mr. Parker in October last.

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We are more than pleased with the number of subscribers received since our last issue, and in return for your promptness shall promise to give a year’s subscriptions worth of valuable information in each succeeding issue.

What has become of the “Standard Directory” to be published by A. E. Southworth & Co., of Woodstock. Ill’s., and to appear January 10th, 1886? We have heard several complaints of its non-appearance. Echo answers.

Go! Get thee to work!! You have only one more month to compete for premiums offered (on the inside of front cover page) to club-getters. So go

to work at once, and perhaps you will be the one to carry off the “pie.” Don’t wait one moment, but “make hay while the sun shines.”

We had a very pleasant call from Dr. F. L. Yoakum, of Tyler, Texas, one of the leading scientists of the state. His stay was short, but exceedingly interesting. When visiting our city again we shall be pleased to have him call, as he will be doubly welcomed.

If all goes satisfactory this month, I will enlarge with the May number; also enlarge the subscription price. So do not wait, but subscribe at once, and you will save money.

EXCHANGES AND WANTS.

Brief exchange or want notices, not exceeding thirty words, will be inserted free in this column to subscribers only. Notices over thirty words will be charged at the rate of one-half cent per word. To outsiders, 25 cents for each insertion; cash with order.

I wish to exchange the coming season with good collectors, especially on the coast and in the south. My sets of eggs will be rare and first-class. Exchange limited. No postals answered.

FRED M. DILLE,

Greeley, Colorado.

Kind Words.

Yesterday's mail brought me what I have been anxiously looking for—THE SUNNY SOUTH OOLOGIST. It is very neat, and I do hope you will get enough subscribers to continue and enlarge.

FRED. M. DILLE,

Greeley, Col.

Your magazine is at hand, and I just have time to say that I am exceedingly well pleased with the articles in your periodical; they are far above the average.

OLIVER DAVIE,

Columbus, Ohio.

I have read its pages, and am pleased with your large circle of Oological correspondents and your undoubted ability as an editor. It should prove of sufficient value to the collectors of the country to make it take its proper place in the literature of the subject; not only because of your generous and gentlemanly treatment of me in the past at all times, but because I believe THE SUNNY SOUTH OOLOGIST to have a live and intelligent Oologist at its head.

HARRY G. PARKER,

Chester, Pa.

“THE SUNNY SOUTH OOLOGIST,” is the title of a scientific publication issued by our young townsman, E. C. Davis; No. 1 of volume 1 of which is on our table. It is a credit to the young gentleman, and to our city. We wish the enterprise success.—Gainesville Daily Hesperian.

The first number of THE SUNNY SOUTH OOLOGIST is at hand, and I am more than pleased with it and its contents.

V. E. PISTON,

Rockland, Me.

CORRESPONDENCE.

Anyone desiring questions answered relating to Birds, their Nests and Eggs, will favor us by sending them in, and we will answer them through this column to the best of our ability.

On the 28th of March, 1885, I found a nest of the Red-shouldered Hawk, containing two eggs, which I took. Returning seven days later, and seeing the bird fly from the nest, I concluded to take another look at it, and was very much surprised to find two more eggs, although the shells were much lighter marked than those taken previously, which went to prove they were deposited by the same bird.

J. H. B.,

Oswego, Kansas.

Last summer, while out collecting, I found a three-storied nest of the Summer Yellow bird. Each story contained one egg of the Cow bird, and two of the Warblers. I also found a double nest of the Bronzed Grackle containing nine eggs; four in the lower part, and five in the upper. The total number of eggs from both nests were eighteen. Don't you think this a pretty good haul from two nests?

W. A. W.

Quincy, Ill's.

I like the appearance of your paper very much, and trust it will be a financial success.

D. H. EATON

Woburn, Mass.

It is said that alligators' eggs are esteemed by the natives of the regions where those reptiles abound. Mr. Joseph, in his "History of Trinidad," says that he found the eggs of the cayman very good. The female alligator lays from 120 to 160 eggs. They are about as large as the eggs of a turkey, and have a rough shell filled with a thick albumen.

There is an eagles nest on the stump of an old tree in the middle of Caddo lake, near Jefferson, Texas, and a pair of eagles have occupied this as their home for more than twenty years.

Blue-fronted Jay.

(CYANOCITTA STELLERI FRONTALIS.)

One would, with a general knowledge of the nesting habits of the Jays, look for their nests in trees and bushes; but with the recent observations on the habits of this bird, by N. S. Goss, in the *Auk*, April, 1885, we have additional light thrown upon the subject. He found quite a number of nests of the Blue-fronted Jay in the vicinity of Julian, California, in the spring of 1884, and “in all cases but one, in holes and trough-like cavities in trees and stubs, ranging from four to fifty feet from the ground, generally ten to twenty feet. The nest found outside was built upon a large horizontal limb of an oak close beside a gnarl, the sprout-like limbs of which thickly covered the nest overhead, and almost hid it from view below.” They were quite bulky, loosely made of sticks, stems of weeds, and lined with fibrous rootlets and grasses; and, as they were all built at or near the opening, the tell-tale sticks projected and made the finding of the nests not difficult. Mr. Goss gives the color of the eggs as light blue, speckled and spotted with dark brown, rather thickest at large end, and the measurements of two sets, as follows: One taken May 19, 1.20 by .87, 1.20 by .88, 1.21 by .88; May 21, 1.22 by .88, 1.15 by .86, 1.19 by .86, 1.16 by .85.

Mr. W. O. Emerson informs me that he finds the nests in the vicinity of Haywards, Cal., placed in oaks, redwood and other tall trees.

The above interesting article is an extract from *Davies’ New Key to the Nests and Eggs of North American Birds*, taken from specimen leaves sent me, and of which is a fair sample of descriptions of the nests and eggs of each bird contained in that book.—EDITOR.

Birds of Pennsylvania.

The following data is taken from notes made during a series of years, all within this state, and all from personal observation.

("C" means common, "R" means rare.)

1. Wood Thrush. (C). Breeds May 1st, to June 15th. Nests generally placed in thick woods, near clearings.

2. Wilson's Thrush. (R). Breeds June 2nd. Nests placed in thickets, with southern exposure.

7. American Robin. (C). Breeds May 1st to July 25th. Nests made near habitations, in trees, outhouses, anywhere almost.

11. Mocking Bird. (R). Only one known instance in Delaware county.

12. Catbird. (C). Breeds May 15th to July 1st. Nests placed in gardens or clearings of woods, always near man.

13. Brown Thrasher. (C). Breeds May 15th to June 20th. Nests found in blackberry tangle or thickets, high or lowland.

22. Bluebird. (C). Breeds May 1st to July 20th. Nests found anywhere, in bird boxes, natural holes in trees, etc.

41. Black-capped Chickadee. (C). Breeds May 10th to 25th. Nests found in timber cleared districts, in stumps about 6 feet high.

51. White-bellied Nuthatch. (R). Breeds April 15th to May 1st. Nests found in excavated holes, remote from habitation.

60. Carolina Wren. (C). Breeds April 8th to May 10th, (two broods). Nests found about rocks, remote from habitation.

63. House Wren. (C). Breeds May 15th to June 10th. Nests found in Orchards, or about farm houses.

67. Long-billed Marsh Wren. (C). Breeds June 12th to 18th. Nest found in low, fresh meadows.

93. Summer Yellowbird. (C). Breeds June 10th to 20th. Nests found near running water, in low, flat country.

99. Chestnut-sided Warbler. (R). Breeds June 20th. Nests found in pastures, or small woods.

115. Golden-crowned Thrush (C). Breeds June 10th to 25th. Nests found on the ground, in deep woods.

123. Yellow-breasted Chat. (C). Breeds May 28th to June 10th. Nests found in upland thickets, southern exposure.

128. American Redstart. (R). Breeds June 15th. Nests placed near roadsides.

135. Red eyed Vireo. (C). Breeds June 10th to 20th. Nest found in woods of young trees, not over ten feet from the ground.

139. Warbling Vireo. (C). Breeds June 10th to 20th. Nests placed in trees, generally 25 feet from the ground, or more.

143. White-eyed Vireo. (R). Breeds June 10th to 20th. Nests placed in blackberry thickets, near the ground.

151. Cedar Waxwing. (C). Breeds June 15th to 25th. Nests generally found in orchards.

152. Purple Martin. (C). Breeds June 2nd. Nests placed in bird boxes.

153. Cliff Swallow. (C). Breeds June 1st to 5th. Nests placed in barns and under eaves.

154. Barn Swallow. (C). Breeds June 1st to 15th. Nests placed in barns.

155. White-bellied Swallow. (R). Breeds June 1st to 15th. Nests placed in bird boxes.

157. Bank Swallow. (C). Breeds May 22 to June 1st. Nest placed in sand banks, etc., at the end of a burrow. 22

161. Scarlet Tanager. (C). Breeds June 10th. Nest found in deep woods.

E. S. English Sparrow. (C). Too well known to detail.

181. American Goldfinch. (C). Breeds from July 15th to Aug. 20th. Nests found by a roadside, or in orchards.

197. Grass Finch. (C). Breeds June 10th. Nests placed in pastures or meadow.

198. Yellow-winged Sparrow. (R). Breeds June 25th. Nests placed in meadows or pasture.

211. Chipping Sparrow. (C). Breeds May 8th to June 30th. Nests near houses or in parks.

214. Field Sparrow. (C). Breeds May 1st to June 10th. Nests placed on or near the ground, in high country generally.

231. Song Sparrow. (C). Breeds May 1st to June 30th. (three broods). Nests found anywhere.

233. Swamp Sparrow. (R). Breeds July 4th. Nests placed in swampy meadows.

237. Chewink; Towhee. (C). Breeds June 1st to 15th. Nests placed on the ground in open woodland.

242. Cardinal Grosbeak. (C). Breeds April 20th to May 30th. Nests found in wooded tangle and briars.

244. Rose-breasted Grosbeak. (R). Breeds June 10th. Nests found in borders of woods.

248. Indigo Bunting. (C). Breeds June 2nd. Nests placed in blackberry tangle in open fields.

257. Bobolink. (R). Seldom found breeding in southern Pennsylvania.

258. Cowbird. (C). Breeds from April to August. Eggs placed in nests of Pewees, Sparrows, Chats, Tanagers, etc.

261. Red and Black, Sh'd Blackbird. (C). Breeds May 20th to June 20th. Nests placed on the ground, or in low bushes in swampy places.

263. Meadow Lark. (C). Breeds May 20th to June 30th. Nests placed in dry pastures and fields.

270. Orchard Oriole. (C). Breeds June 5th to 20th. Nests placed in orchards.

271. Baltimore Oriole. (C). Breeds June 5th to 20th. Nests found near houses generally.

278. Purple Grackle. (C). Breeds April 25th. Nesting in colonies, in cedar trees.

282. Common Crow. (C). Breeds April 15th to 30th. Nests placed in very high trees in woods.

289. Blue Jay. (R). Breeds April 15th to 30th. Nests found in deep woods.

304. Kingbird. (C). Breeds June 1st to 20th. Nests placed in sycamore trees, or in orchards.

312. Gt. Crested Flycatcher. (C). Breeds June 1st to 20th. Nests found in orchards, in natural cavities of trees.

315. Pewee; Phœbebird. (C). Breeds April 20th to June 10th. Nests placed under bridges or eaves of small spring houses, etc.

320. Wood Pewee. (C). Breeds June 1st. Nests placed in woods or orchards.

324. Acadian Flycatcher. (C). Breeds June 5th to 20th. Nests found near running water or sloping ground.

335. Ruby-throated Hummingbird. (R). Breeds June 1st to 15th. Nests found near a spring of water in orchard or woods.

351. Chimney Swift. (C). Breeds July 1st to 15th. Nests placed in chimneys.

357. Night Hawk. (C). Breeds June 1st to 20th. Nests placed on bare 23 ground on an elevated plateau.

361. Downy Woodpecker. (R). Breeds in May. Nests placed in excavated holes in woods.

575. Red-headed Woodpecker. (C). Breeds June 15th. Nests placed in solitary trees in fields.

378. Yellow-shafted Flicker. (C). Breeds May 15th to June 15th. Nests placed anywhere.

382. Belted Kingfisher. (C). Breeds May 10th to June 15th. Nests placed in holes in banks along streams in low lands.

387. Yellow-billed Cuckoo. (C). Breeds June 5th to 12th. Nests placed in densest thickets of bramble and grapevine.

388. Black-billed Cuckoo. (C). Breeds same as preceding species.

394. Am. Barn Owl. (R). Breeds April 1st to 15th. Nests placed in dead trees, on low meadow lands.

402. Little Screech Owl. (C). Breeds April 1st to 15th. Nests placed in beech trees, or apple trees.

420. Sparrow Hawk. (C). Breeds May 1st to June 1st. Nests placed in holes of dead trees, anywhere.

425. Fish Hawk. Common in New Jersey, but rare in Pennsylvania.

431. Cooper's Hawk. (C). Breeds April 10th to May 1st. Nests generally placed in deep and solitary woods, in large trees.

432. Sharp-shinned Hawk. (R). Same as 431.

436. Red-tailed Hawk. (R), Same as 431.

439. Red-shouldered Hawk. (R). Same as 431.

443. Broad-winged Hawk. (R). Same as 431.

460. Mourning Dove. (C). Breeds May 1st to June 30th (2 broods). Nests found remote from man, in silent places.

480. Bobwhite. (C). Breeds May 20th to June 30th. Nests on the ground in field or pasture.

494. Green Heron. (C). Breeds May 10th to June 10th. Nests placed in large trees, sometimes in orchards near swamps.

516. Killdeer. (C). Breeds June 1st to 15th. Eggs placed on ground (no nest), on a slope near water.

557. Spotted Sandpiper. (C). Breeds June 1st to 15th. No nest. Eggs placed on the ground, on a slope near water.

The Rails breed plentifully on New Jersey coast, but sparsely in Pennsylvania.

613. Summer Duck. (R). Breeds May to June 15th. Nest placed in hollow tree near water.

In filling out the above data, I have omitted several species which occasionally breed here.

HARRY G. PARKER.

Chester, Delaware Co., Pa.

Nesting of the Long-eared Owl.

(ASIO AMERICANUS)

For the Sunny South Oologist:

It was on the bright spring morning of April 25, 1885, that a friend and myself started for the big woods in search of hawks', crows', etc., eggs.

We first went to a crows' nest we found building the Saturday before, and were most fortunate in securing 3 fresh eggs. This was comparatively a good find, owing to the scarcity of that bird in this locality.

We next made our way to a tammerac swamp, and on the edge we went a little out of our way to look at an old crow's nest that we knew of, for mere curiosity sake. In the center of the nest two prongs poked out and we thought they were two sticks sticking up; but, to be sure, my friend kicked on the tree, and to my great joy the two prongs moved. At this my friend began to climb the tree, and when about half way up, a large yellowish-brown bird flew sluggishly off the nest, and I could see it was an owl, but what kind I was uncertain. When he reached the nest and shouted down there were 5 eggs in it, I was so excited that I went up and helped him down with them, although there was no need of it. They were of a clear white, and almost globular in form, and measured about 1.60 x 1.40 inches. We imagined them to be all kinds of owls, and were very anxious to find out what they were.

We hunted around now until noon and then sat down by a spring and ate our dinner, which we had brought with us. After a little "lounge" in the sun after our meal, we started out again, and by 3 o'clock p. m., had found nothing but last year's nests. About 3:30 we came to another tammerac swamp, and in the center there was an old marsh hawk's nest I was acquainted with, and we made for it, thinking there might be an owl's nest in it, and you may imagine my delight at seeing the same kind of horns sticking up in the

center. This nest was only about 7 feet from the ground, and as soon as I kicked the tree the owl flew off and lit on a limb close by, and I identified her as being a long-eared owl. I regretted that I did not have my gun with me, or I would have had her this day all mounted. I climbed the tree, and in the nest found four more eggs just like those in the first nest, and now our minds were lightened.

As it was getting time to be going home, we started, and on arriving, blew our eggs and found them to be fresh; and one of the sets now glow in the collection of the editor of this paper.

I have found several sets besides this, and know of others being found around here, and they invariably occupy other birds' nests.

GEO. G. CANTWELL,

Minneapolis, Minn.

The Road-runner; Chaparral Cock.

(GEOCOCCYX CALIFORNIANUS).

For the Sunny South Oologist:

This species (which may be described as a rather long tail with a small bird on the “for’ard” end of it) occurs rarely in this locality. Ornithologists generally give the number of eggs in a set as “6 to 9.” I had previously taken several sets, containing from two to four eggs; and finding a nest with two eggs on May 8th, 1885, I concluded to give the bird a chance to fill out the set. The nest was placed in the bushy top of a small black-jack oak, about twelve feet from the ground. It was a bulky structure 16 inches in diameter, 5 inches in depth, and nearly flat on the top—not more than an inch deep, built of large sticks, twigs, and weeds in the lining. I visited the nest on the 9th and 10th, and although the bird was “tu hum” every time, the set had not increased any in number. During the 11th, 12th and 13th, three more eggs were added to the set, making five in all. I waited until the 19th, when, as no more eggs were laid, I took the nest, shooting the female. On dissection I found that within the next two or three days two more eggs would have been added to the set. Incubation was about one-half advanced in two of the eggs. The question is, can I call this a full set? The female when flushed from the nest would fly to the ground, and all to be seen of her afterwards was a streak. They are famous runners, and it takes a fast “pony” to overtake them.

J. A. SINGLEY,

Giddings, Texas.

The Chinese pheasants turned loose in Oregon some time since have interbred with the native grouse, and a new game bird with the head of a pheasant and wing and tail feathers of a grouse is the result.

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